

LIFE STAGES

Not only is it possible and safe to practice yoga during different life stages—from childhood to pregnancy to old age—but research is now building to show that yoga and its accompanying practices, such as meditation, can have additional benefits at these times of life.

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*Yoga emphasizes the **whole child**, so it fulfills an important need for **social and emotional learning**.*

There are over
900
“yoga in school”
programs in
North America.



Did you know?

RESEARCH SUGGESTS THAT YOGA COULD **IMPROVE** CORE SYMPTOMS OF ATTENTION DEFICIT HYPERACTIVITY DISORDER (ADHD) SUCH AS INATTENTION, HYPERACTIVITY, AND IMPULSIVITY, IN **CHILDREN** AND ADOLESCENTS, WHEN PRACTICED AS A **MIND-BODY** THERAPY AND FORM OF EXERCISE.

Q DOES YOGA BENEFIT CHILDREN?

A focus on academic performance can result in children sitting for long periods of time and can lead to other vital life skills being overlooked. As a holistic practice, yoga emphasizes the whole child, so it fulfills an important need for social and emotional learning (SEL). Yoga can affect all components of the social and emotional learning model, which include:

- **Self-awareness:** recognizing and identifying emotions
- **Self-management:** regulating emotions and managing stress
- **Social awareness:** acknowledging the perspectives of others
- **Relationship skills:** creating and maintaining a social network
- **Responsible decisions:** making conscious, positive decisions.

A review of research from Harvard and the Kripalu Center for Yoga and Health, for example, found that using yoga therapeutically was a viable way to improve the physical and mental health of children and adolescents. Meditation programs in schools have also shown strong improvements in resilience to stress and cognitive performance.